

Give a Progress Update on a Task or Project

Narrate

PPF

Timeline Reconstruction

Name: _____ Date: _____

SLIDE 02 Today's goal

By the end of this lesson, I can:

Give a clear progress update: what you have done, where things are now, what happens next, and what is still open.

- WHO** Three weeks ago your manager, Mr. Tan, asked you to clean up the customer contact list (about 900 contacts).
- SITUATION** It is Monday morning. In the team meeting, Mr. Tan asks how the list is going. He has five minutes and wants to know if it will be ready for the newsletter.
- NEED** He needs the update in order: what is done, what you are doing now, what comes next – and anything you need from him.
- GOAL** Give an organised update (Past → Present → Future) and say clearly what is still open.
-

SLIDE 03 Try it first

Mr. Tan asks: "Morning. Can you give me a quick update on the customer list?" Say something for 30 seconds. Then note what you said.

SLIDE 04 A good message

Ali's answer. Mark where each part starts.

Three weeks ago I started cleaning up the customer list. So far, I've checked about 600 of the 900 contacts and removed the duplicates. At the moment, I'm checking the last 300 and calling the customers with no email address. There are still about 80 calls to go. I'm going to finish the calls by Friday. After that, I'll send you the final list, and then we can use it for the newsletter. One thing: some customers have changed company, so I need your decision on whether to keep them.

P

PAST · WHAT IS DONE

P

PRESENT · WHERE WE ARE NOW

F

FUTURE · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

!

STILL OPEN

SLIDE 05 Organise it

Mei Ling updates Mr. Tan on the new invoice template: done → now → next → still open.

- ☐ Right now, we're testing it with five customers.
- ☐ One thing to note: two customers still want paper invoices, so I need to know if that's okay.
- ☐ Next Monday, I'll fix any problems, and then we can switch every customer to the new template.
- ☐ Last week I finished the new invoice design and sent it to the accounts team.

Write the letter: **P** = Past · what is done · **P** = Present · where we are now · **F** = Future · what happens next · **!** = Still open

SLIDE 06 Useful language

Tick the expressions you used today.

PAST · WHAT IS DONE

☐ Three weeks ago, I started ...

☐ So far, I've ...

☐ Last week, we finished ...

☐ I've already ...

PRESENT · WHERE WE ARE NOW

☐ At the moment, I'm ...

☐ Right now, we're ...

☐ There are still ... to go.

☐ We're on track.

FUTURE · WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

☐ Next, I'm going to ...

☐ By Friday, I'll ...

☐ After that, ...

☐ Then we can ...

STILL OPEN

☐ One thing to note: ...

☐ I need your decision on ...

☐ The only problem is ...

SLIDE 07 Connect the ideas

Choose the connector and write the new sentence.

1. I checked the contacts. [**First ... then ... / but / because**] I removed the duplicates.

2. I'll finish the calls by Friday. [**After that, / However, / For example,**] I'll send you the list.

3. Some customers have changed company. [**so / but / then**] I need your decision.

4. Most of the list is done. [**so / but / because**] About 80 contacts still have no email address.

SLIDE 08 Time control

Circle the right form. Why?

1. Three weeks ago I _____ the clean-up. (A finished step, with a time)

☐ start

☐ started

☐ have started

2. So far, I _____ 600 contacts. (What is done so far, no exact time)

☐ checked

☐ have checked

☐ am checking

3. At the moment, I _____ the customers with no email address. (What is happening right now)

☐ call

☐ called

☐ am calling

4. I _____ finish the calls by Friday. (A plan)

☐ am going to

☐ was

☐ have

SLIDE 09 Present Perfect for 'so far'

When you say what is done up to now, without an exact time, use have / has + past participle. Add so far, already, not yet.

So far, I've checked 600 contacts.

We've already removed the duplicates.

I haven't called everyone yet.

Some customers **have changed** company.

SLIDE 10 Build your message

Fill each part. This is what you will say in the task.



PAST · DONE

... ago, I started ... So far, I've ...



PRESENT · NOW

At the moment, I'm ...



FUTURE · NEXT

Next, I'm going to ... By ..., I'll ...



STILL OPEN

One thing to note: ...

SLIDE 11 Timeline Reconstruction

A gives an update from a timeline card. B listens, rebuilds the timeline in order, then asks what comes next.

1. A looks at a timeline card (the facts are mixed up) and gives the update in order: done → now → next → still open.
2. B listens and writes the events in order (workbook). No looking at the card.
3. B asks two questions: 'When will it be ready?' and 'Anything you need from me?'
4. Swap roles with the second card.

Card 1 · New company website

Need: team photos · Testing on phones: now ·
Started: 6 weeks ago · Go live: after the fixes ·
Done: home page, product pages · Fix problems:
by Friday

Card 2 · Office move

Set up the internet: after the move · Found the
new office: 2 months ago · Packing files: now ·
Question: who keeps the old keys? · Move: on the
15th · Done: signed the contract, ordered
furniture

Card 3 · Staff training

Problem: two people are on leave on the 20th ·
Collecting replies: now (12 of 20) · Chose the
course: 1 month ago · Confirm the room: next
week · Training: on the 20th · Done: booked the
trainer, sent the invitations

Partner's timeline, in order:

My partner's question or concern, and what I answered:

SLIDE 12 Respond

Mr. Tan asks. Write a short answer to one of these.

1. Why is it taking longer than planned?
2. Can you finish it by Wednesday instead of Friday?
3. What happens if some customers don't answer the phone?

Start with: **The reason is that ... · I can try, but ... · If that happens, I'll ...**

SLIDE 13 Transfer

A friend asks how your fitness plan (or your home renovation) is going. Give an update: what you have done, what you are doing now, what is next.

Two months ago I started ... · So far, I've ... · Right now, I'm ... · Next, I'm going to ...

SLIDE 14 Did I do it?

Be honest. Tick what you did in the task.

☐

Events come in a clear order: done → now → next.

☐

Uses time words (ago, so far, at the moment, by Friday).

☐

Says clearly what is still open or needed.

SLIDE 15 Feedback: how can I improve?

Circle one number for each area. 1 = I need help · 2 = OK · 3 = Good

Clear order (past → now → next)

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Time words

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Present Perfect for 'so far'

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Saying what is still open

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

Confidence

☐ 1

☐ 2

☐ 3

My improvement action: Next time, I will _____.

WE BELIEVE IN THE POWER OF PRACTICAL SPEAKING TO INSPIRE CONFIDENCE

After class: open the After class review